

D576

Industrial and Organizational Psychology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A regional logistics firm with 400 employees and a newly hired HR director wants a better way to hire warehouse supervisors. The CEO likes a personality test that a larger competitor uses. What should HR do first?

- A. Interview every applicant informally and hire the best overall fit.
- B. Write the training curriculum for new supervisors.
- C. Adopt the competitor's personality test, since it is already in use in the industry.
- D. Conduct a job analysis to identify the supervisor tasks and the KSAOs needed to do them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A call center tests applicants' typing speed. Applicants who retake the test two weeks later get nearly the same scores (test-retest $r = .92$). The vendor says 200 companies use it. The agents spend almost all day talking with customers and type very little. What is the best conclusion?

- A. The test is unreliable because agents rarely type.
- B. The test is valid because the retest correlation is .92.
- C. The test is valid because 200 companies use it.
- D. The test is reliable, but its validity for this job is doubtful.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Scores on a new structured interview correlate .45 with supervisors' performance ratings of the same hires one year later. What does this evidence show?

- A. Criterion-related (predictive) validity.
- B. Only that the interview is reliable, not that it is valid.
- C. Face validity, because applicants see the interview as fair.
- D. Test-retest reliability.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

At a large hospital, hiring managers, several with more than 20 years of experience, ask each candidate whatever questions come to mind and give an overall fit rating. The offer acceptance rate is 85%. Which change would most improve how well interviews predict job performance?

- A. Ask every candidate the same job-related questions and score answers on anchored rating scales.
- B. Drop interviews completely and hire from résumés alone.
- C. Add a second unstructured interview with a different manager.
- D. Have only the most experienced managers conduct interviews.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Account managers at a mid-size insurance agency, which recently moved into a new office, are currently told to do their best on renewals. Last quarter's renewal rate was 70%. Which goal best fits goal-setting theory?

- A. Hold renewals at 70% next quarter.
- B. Do your best to improve renewals next quarter.
- C. Reach 100% renewals next quarter.
- D. Raise renewals from 70% to 78% by the end of next quarter, with weekly progress reports.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

Technicians at a plant highly value a \$2,000 performance bonus (valence 0.9) and believe hard work will raise their output (expectancy 0.8). But for three years managers have never paid the bonus even when targets were met, so instrumentality is 0. The plant has won two safety awards. Using expectancy theory, what is the motivational force?

- A. 0.9
- B. 1.7
- C. 0
- D. 0.72

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An employee's expectancy is 0.5 and valence is 0.8. The manager wants a motivational force of at least 0.32. What is the minimum instrumentality needed?

- A.** 0.4
- B.** 0.8
- C.** 0.5
- D.** 0.128

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An accounting firm raised salaries 8%, renovated the break room, and fixed a parking problem. Complaints dropped sharply, yet the engagement survey shows staff are no more motivated than before. The firm is based in a downtown office tower. According to Herzberg, what should the firm do next?

- A.** Add motivators such as more responsibility, recognition, and growth opportunities.
- B.** Raise salaries another 8%.
- C.** Move to a more attractive building.
- D.** Nothing; once complaints stop, employees are always motivated.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Engineers at a software company have meaningful projects, public recognition, and clear promotion paths, but their pay is 15% below market and many say they are unhappy with it. What does Herzberg's theory predict?

- A.** They will be neither satisfied nor dissatisfied.
- B.** Strong motivators cancel out the low pay, so no dissatisfaction remains.
- C.** They can be motivated by the work yet still dissatisfied until pay is fixed.
- D.** Raising pay will create lasting motivation because pay is a motivator.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

After a two-day customer-service workshop held at a lakeside resort, 94% of attendees rated it excellent. Three months later, supervisors listened to live calls and found most agents were using the new de-escalation steps. Which Kirkpatrick level does the supervisors' observation measure?

- A.** Level 1, reaction.
- B.** Level 3, behavior.
- C.** Level 2, learning.
- D.** Level 4, results.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A warehouse wants to know whether its new safety training reduced lost-time injuries over the following year. Which Kirkpatrick level is this?

- A.** Any level, because all four measure the same thing.
- B.** Level 3, behavior.
- C.** Level 4, results.
- D.** Level 2, learning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

Intensive-care nurses at a 300-bed hospital face heavy workloads and frequent emotional strain, and turnover rose to 22% last year. Leadership plans a single wellness webinar urging staff to be more resilient. Which plan best fits the job demands-resources model?

- A.** Hire only applicants who score high on a resilience test.
- B.** Add job resources such as schedule input, peer support, and regular supervisor feedback, while cutting avoidable demands.
- C.** Remove all emotional demands from the job.
- D.** Hold the wellness webinar and change nothing else.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A regional logistics firm ~~with 400 employees and a newly hired HR director~~ wants a better way to hire warehouse supervisors. ~~The CEO likes a personality test that a larger competitor uses.~~ What should HR do first?

Target word: first step in building a selection system **Decides:** Selection tools must be based on what the job actually requires.

A	Adjacent category	A selection method, not the analysis that should define it, and an unstructured one at that.
B	Confusion set	Training design is also built from the job analysis, so it cannot come first.
C	Camouflage	Responds to the CEO's preference; another firm's use does not show the test fits this job.
D	Correct	Job analysis defines what to measure; tests and interviews are chosen after it.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A call center tests applicants' typing speed. Applicants who retake the test two weeks later get nearly the same scores (test-retest $r = .92$). ~~The vendor says 200 companies use it.~~ The agents spend almost all day talking with customers and type very little. What is the best conclusion?

Target word: reliable vs. valid for this job **Decides:** Scores are consistent, but typing is barely part of the job.

A	Adjacent category	Low job relevance is a validity problem; reliability is about score consistency, which is high.
B	Confusion set	Test-retest correlation is evidence of reliability, not validity.
C	Camouflage	Popularity is not validity evidence.
D	Correct	$r = .92$ shows consistency; it does not show the test measures what agents actually do.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

Scores on a new structured interview correlate .45 with supervisors' performance ratings of the same hires one year later. What does this evidence show?

Target word: name the kind of evidence **Decides:** Scores are linked to a later job-performance criterion.

A	Correct	A correlation between a selection score and later job performance is predictive validity evidence.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the evidence: a link to later performance speaks to validity.
C	Adjacent category	Face validity is about appearance to test takers; no applicant opinions were measured.
D	Confusion set	Retest reliability compares the same measure given twice, not a measure with job performance.

4. Answer A Concept 3

At a large hospital, hiring managers, ~~several with more than 20 years of experience~~, ask each candidate whatever questions come to mind and give an overall fit rating. ~~The offer acceptance rate is 85%.~~ Which change would most improve how well interviews predict job performance?

Target word: best way to improve interview prediction **Decides:** Questions and ratings vary by manager and candidate.

A	Correct	Structure and job relevance raise both reliability and validity of interviews.
B	Absolute language	Well-structured interviews are among the stronger predictors; removing them loses information.
C	Dropped element	More interviews without structure keep the core weakness.
D	Camouflage	Leans on the years-of-experience detail; experience does not fix unstructured format.

5. Answer D Concept 4

Account managers at a mid-size insurance agency, ~~which recently moved into a new office~~, are currently told to do their best on renewals. Last quarter's renewal rate was 70%. Which goal best fits goal-setting theory?

Target word: best goal wording **Decides:** Specific, challenging, attainable, with feedback.

A	Adjacent category	Specific but not challenging, so it does not raise performance.
B	Dropped element	Keeps the vague wording; lacks a specific target.
C	Absolute language	An impossible goal lowers commitment and effort.
D	Correct	Specific, measurable, challenging yet reachable, and paired with feedback.

6. Answer C Concept 5

Technicians at a plant highly value a ~~\$2,000~~ performance bonus (valence 0.9) and believe hard work will raise their output (expectancy 0.8). But for three years managers have never paid the bonus even when targets were met, so instrumentality is 0. ~~The plant has won two safety awards.~~ Using expectancy theory, what is the motivational force?

Target word: motivational force **Decides:** Instrumentality is zero, and the terms multiply.

A	Wrong stem number	The valence alone.
B	Inverted operation	Adds $0.8 + 0 + 0.9$ instead of multiplying.
C	Correct	$0.8 \times 0 \times 0.9 = 0$; a broken performance-to-reward link wipes out motivation.
D	Dropped element	0.8×0.9 leaves out instrumentality.

7. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

An employee's expectancy is 0.5 and valence is 0.8. The manager wants a motivational force of at least 0.32. What is the minimum instrumentality needed?

Target word: solve for instrumentality **Decides:** $0.32 / (0.5 \times 0.8)$.

A	Dropped element	That is expectancy $\times$ valence, not the missing term.
B	Correct	$0.5 \times 0.8 = 0.40$; $0.32 / 0.40 = 0.8$.
C	Wrong stem number	The expectancy value given in the stem.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies 0.32 by 0.40 instead of dividing.

8. Answer A Concept 6

An accounting firm raised salaries 8%, renovated the break room, and fixed a parking problem. Complaints dropped sharply, yet the engagement survey shows staff are no more motivated than before. ~~The firm is based in a downtown office tower.~~ According to Herzberg, what should the firm do next?

Target word: next step after hygiene fixes **Decides:** Hygiene fixes removed dissatisfaction; motivators are missing.

A	Correct	Motivators create satisfaction; hygiene factors only prevent dissatisfaction.
B	Adjacent category	Pay is a hygiene factor; more of it will not create lasting motivation.
C	Camouflage	Reacts to the office-tower detail; working conditions are hygiene.
D	Absolute language	Herzberg treats no dissatisfaction and satisfaction as separate states.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

Engineers at a software company have meaningful projects, public recognition, and clear promotion paths, but their pay is 15% below market and many say they are unhappy with it. What does Herzberg's theory predict?

Target word: effect of a missing hygiene factor when motivators are present **Decides:** Motivators and hygiene act on separate scales.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the motivators already present.
B	Inverted operation	Treats the two factors as one scale where one offsets the other.
C	Correct	Motivators do not remove dissatisfaction caused by a hygiene gap.
D	Confusion set	Pay is a hygiene factor in Herzberg's model.

10. Answer B Concept 7

After a two-day customer-service workshop ~~held at a lakeside resort, 94% of attendees rated it excellent.~~ Three months later, supervisors listened to live calls and found most agents were using the new de-escalation steps. Which Kirkpatrick level does the supervisors' observation measure?

Target word: level of the supervisors' observation **Decides:** Watching use of the skill on the job.

A	Camouflage	Answers the 94% satisfaction rating, not the observation.
B	Correct	Observing whether trainees apply skills on the job is behavior.
C	Adjacent category	Learning is measured by tests of knowledge or skill at the end of training.
D	Confusion set	Results are business outcomes such as complaints or retention, not observed behavior.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A warehouse wants to know whether its new safety training reduced lost-time injuries over the following year. Which Kirkpatrick level is this?

Target word: level for an organizational outcome **Decides:** Injury rate is a business result.

A	Absolute language	Each level measures a different outcome.
B	Adjacent category	Behavior would be observing safe practices, not counting injuries.
C	Correct	Changes in organizational outcomes such as injury rates are Level 4.
D	Confusion set	Learning is a post-training test of knowledge.

12. Answer B Concept 8

Intensive-care nurses ~~at a 300-bed hospital~~ face heavy workloads and frequent emotional strain, and turnover rose to 22% last year. Leadership plans a single wellness webinar urging staff to be more resilient. Which plan best fits the job demands-resources model?

Target word: best burnout-reduction approach **Decides:** Demands are high and resources are low.

A	Adjacent category	Individual selection does not fix a job design problem.
B	Correct	Resources buffer demands; the model targets the job, not only the person.
C	Absolute language	Impossible in intensive care; the aim is balance, not zero demands.
D	Dropped element	Leaves the demand-resource imbalance untouched.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Job analysis comes first	Selection tools and training content must be built from a job analysis that identifies the tasks and the knowledge, skills, abilities, and other traits (KSAOs) the job requires.	Starting with a popular test or a gut sense of the ideal hire.	"What should HR do first?" before hiring or training.
2	Reliability vs. validity	Reliability is consistency of scores; validity is whether the scores measure what they claim and predict job performance. A test can be reliable without being valid.	Treating consistent scores as proof the test predicts performance.	Retest or rater agreement numbers vs. links to later job performance.
3	Structured interviews	Interviews that ask every candidate the same job-related questions and score answers on anchored scales predict performance better than unstructured conversations.	Believing experienced interviewers judge "fit" best by free conversation.	Different questions for each candidate, or an overall gut rating.
4	Goal-setting theory	Specific, challenging but attainable goals with feedback raise performance more than vague or easy goals.	Thinking "do your best" or an impossible stretch goal motivates most.	Several goal wordings to compare.
5	Expectancy theory	Motivational force = expectancy × instrumentality × valence; if any one is zero, motivation is zero.	Adding the three, or assuming a highly valued reward makes up for a broken link.	Workers doubt effort leads to performance or that performance leads to the reward.
6	Herzberg's two factors	Hygiene factors (pay, policies, conditions, supervision) prevent dissatisfaction; motivators (achievement, recognition, responsibility, growth, the work itself) create satisfaction.	Assuming more pay or better conditions produces lasting motivation.	Complaints stopped but motivation did not rise, or the reverse.
7	Kirkpatrick's four levels	Training is evaluated at Level 1 reaction, Level 2 learning, Level 3 on-the-job behavior, and Level 4 organizational results.	Taking high satisfaction ratings as proof the training worked.	What was measured and when: survey, test, observation on the job, or business outcome.
8	Job demands-re sources and resilience	Burnout rises when job demands chronically exceed job resources; adding resources such as autonomy, support, and feedback buffers demands.	Treating resilience as purely an individual trait to be fixed by telling people to cope.	Heavy demands plus low support, and a plan aimed only at the individual.

Course scope (public description): Industrial and Organizational Psychology introduces students to the ways that businesses and other organizations use psychological theories and models to recruit and train new talent, improve overall productivity, and enhance the motivation, resilience, and team dynamics of employees. Students will consider both how to apply these strategies to themselves and how to use them to lead others. There are no prerequisites for this course.